

Chemical Engineering Town Hall Survey Questions and Feedback, October 2024

Department:

- DEI initiative (didn't give any context for this, but I'm assuming they would like to see more)
- Would like to see more events to reach out to underclassmen and have them feel more included in the community
- More study space
- CHE student network portal, it would be good to know who is in each lab and what they are doing and to know who to approach for student experience questions
- Mentoring for PhD advisors

Undergraduate:

- Great Reviews about: CHE 201, 301, 313
- Struggling with: CHE 230, 330, Organic chemistry, "Irrelevant chemistry courses", professor (Achinivu) does not know slide content from polymer class and makes exams too long to complete in given time
- Concerns: Have professors be more invested in teaching, not just here for research

Graduate:

- Great Reviews about: Renewable Energy Technologies
- Need: Updated graduate student handbook (updates to academic requirements)
- Structure PhD program (when prelim happens, limit of publications, expectations of graduation.), structure in lab management
- Student concerns: Unreasonable demands from advisors, micromanagement, celebrating students quitting their labs,
- What are the department plans to improve working conditions for graduate student workers?
- How do you improve graduate student-advisor relationships? "They should be inspiring, collaborative mentors and thought leaders not micromanagers."
- There are cases where PhD students are forced to go without a TA or RA for a semester or two. This has an huge impact, especially for international students who are already living on tight funds and sometimes end up having to leave the department. Furthermore, any research work they have pursued would be held up or abandoned. How will this issue be handled for future students?
- For every student to be admitted there should be clearly defined projects with training and funding plans to ensure the students can execute the projects. Students should not be looking for funding from semester to semester.
- If I enrolled with BEng on the path to Phd ,am I allowed to get a masters degree certificate when done with courses and still continue with my PhD uninterrupted ,for job application purposes?

Things to Share:

Mental Health Issues

UIC Counseling: <https://counseling.uic.edu/>
Concerned for someone: <https://counseling.uic.edu/outreach-and-education/concerned/#more-information>
<https://counseling.uic.edu/outreach-and-education/liaisons-consultation/>